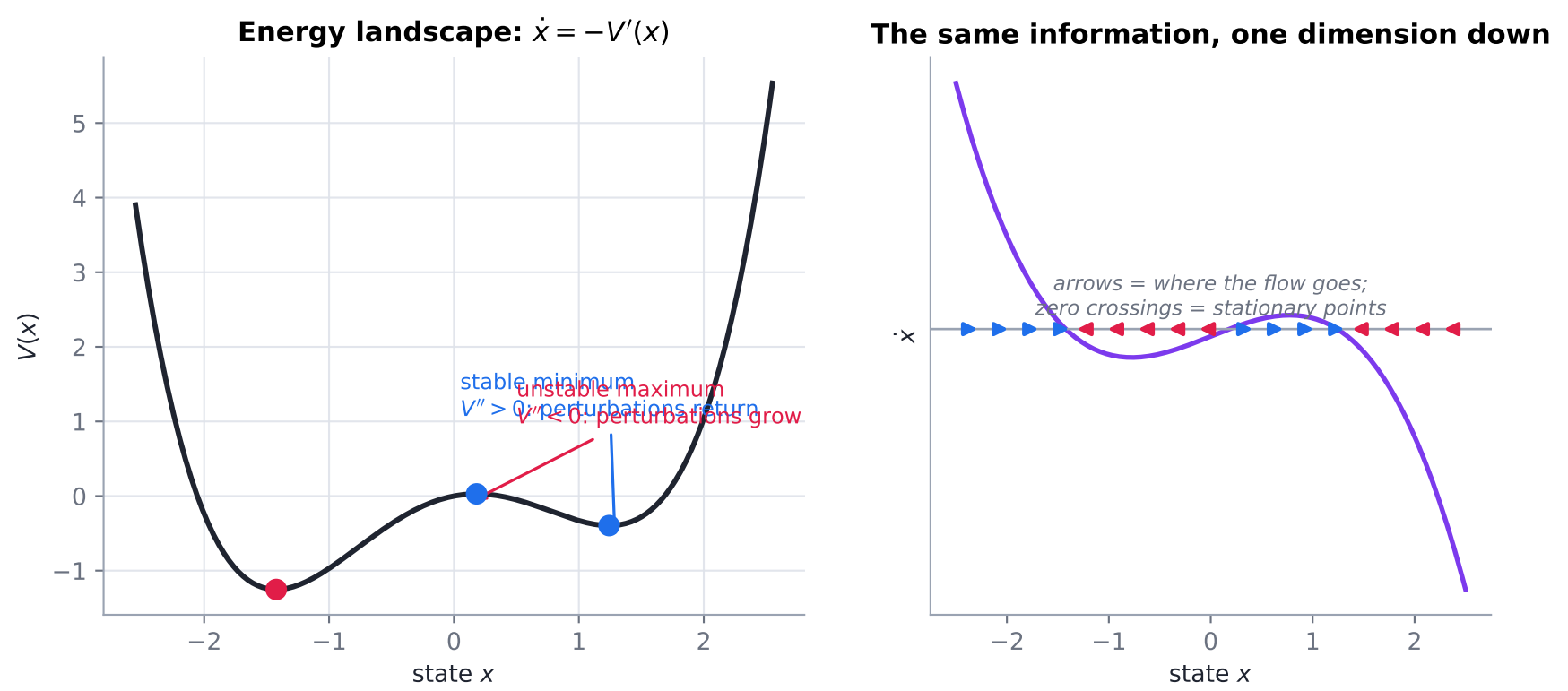
Energy landscape: $\dot{x} = -V'(x)$
$V(x)$
state x
stable minimum
$V'' > 0$: perturbations return
unstable maximum
$V'' < 0$: perturbations grow
The same information, one dimension down
$\dot{x}$
arrows = where the flow goes;
zero crossings = stationary points
state x